Taylor **McKinney**

Software Engineer



About Me

I'm a seasoned senior software engineer with experience delivering displays that get viewed hundreds of millions of times per day around the world and creating the infrastructure to support it. I'm fluent in both Japanese and client-speak, able to communicate with devs, support associates, and clients with ease. I'm always looking forward to building the next big thing, and take pride in ensuring client satisfaction.

Interests

- Web Development
- Web Application Security
- Computer Graphics
- Game Development

Personal

Nationality: USA
Visa Status: Spouse Visa

Contact Info

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Links

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Professional Experience

07/2026 ~ Present
Solutions Architect
Oliver Wyman — Japan - Remote
- Created migration plan to help a leading insurance client modernize their most critical software paths from a traditional monolith application to a cloud-native, microservice-based architecture.
- Performed a deep-dive analysis of their current architecture which organized scattered data from sparse documentation to better understand their current pain points and needs.
- Produced a new target architecture as well as a multi-step plan they can follow to achieve that target over the next few years.

01/2026 ~ 05/2026
Senior Software Engineer - Front End
Paypay Card — Japan - Remote
- Led the project to combine separate web and mobile applications into a single application that supports both platforms.
- Created a new flow for users to report fraudulent purchases and return their cards.
- Redesigned user flows to reduce friction in the most frequent use cases, improving user experience.

Tech stack TypeScript/Vue, Webview

06/2023 ~ 09/2025
Senior Software Engineer - Full Stack
Revcomm Inc. — Japan - Remote
- Built a user management and authentication API, serving a diverse user base of clients, their end-users, and internal staff.
- Engineered and enforced automated security systems that eliminated critical vulnerabilities, preventing potential data leaks of internal passwords and API tokens.
- Pioneered a customizable template system that empowers non-technical team members to manage and brand login pages, removing an entire class of engineering ticket requests.
- Developed and led organization-wide internal technical training courses on core infrastructure (e.g., building tools such as an HTTP server, Redis, SQLite, all from scratch), deepening the developers' understanding of tool internals and improving debugging capabilities.

Tech stack Python/Django, Go, Rust/Leptos, TypeScript/Vue, AWS

05/2022 ~ 05/2023
Senior Software Engineer - Front End
SmartNews — Tokyo, Japan
- Developed a highly performant Webview component for the mobile app, enabling the display of dynamic news content and interactive features not yet supported by native components, reaching over 10 million active users.
- Designed and built a versatile WYSIWYG editor using React, with extensible support for vanilla web components and Svelte components. This tool enabled non-technical content teams to create rich, data-drive pages without engineering support, accelerating content deployment time from days down to minutes.
- Created an internal self-service advertising portal, allowing clients to directly manage ads, ad groups, and campaigns, which reduced the support team's operational workload.

Tech stack TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Svelte, Vue, pnpm, Vite, AWS

Languages

English — Native

Japanese — JLPT N2

Spanish — Basic

Programming Languages

Javascript, Typescript, Odin, Zig, Go, Rust, C, Elixir, C++, C#, GLSL, Slang, Java, Python

Front End

React, Vue.js, SolidJS, Next.js, Create React App, Redux, Webpack, Node, Deno, Bun, Express, Hapi, Vite, Leptos, Material UI, Ant Design, TailwindCSS

Testing

Testing Library, Jest, Vitest, Mocha, AVA, Node Tap, Playwright

Back End

Node, Bun, Deno, Leptos, Axum, Django, Knex.js, Sequelize, MySQL, PostgreSQL, Spring Boot

Cloud

AWS, SQS, SNS, SES, EC2, ECS, EKS, RDS, Lambda, API Gateway, CloudFront, Route 53, VPC, S3, DynamoDB, ElastiCache, AWS Auto Scaling, CloudFormation, CloudWatch, Certificate Manager, KMS, Secrets Manager, GCS, Jenkins, Cirlcle CI

Graphics

OpenGL, Vulkan, Raylib, GLFW, SDL2, SDL3

10/2020 ~ 05/2022 **Senior Software Engineer - Front End**

AXA Life — Tokyo, Japan

- Designed system architecture and built initial prototypes for numerous products and internal applications, navigating internal bureaucracy and establishing scalable patterns adopted company-wide.
- Developed an automated SMS notification system for customer claim updates, improving customer communication transparency and reducing inbound inquiry calls.
- Engineered an internal URL shortener to generate concise links for SMS campaigns, increasing click-through rates by ensuring message clarity.
- Created a universal API authentication gateway, providing a standardized, secure method for all internal teams to protect their services, cutting down initial API development time.
- Led the JavaScript Community of Practices: hosted weekly meet-ups an conducted training sessions for developers sessions on Next.js, internationalization, accessibility, and Redux, upskilling a team of 30+ developers.

Tech stack JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Java, Spring Boot, Python, AWS

05/2019 ~ 02/2020 **Systems Software Engineer - Full Stack**

Netsmile, Inc. — Tokyo, Japan

- Built a client-facing web portal and API service for document upload and OCR processing, streamlining a previously manual workflow.

Tech stack TypeScript, Next.js, React, RabbitMQ, AWS

10/2013 ~ 02/2019 **Software Engineer / Senior Software Engineer**

Bazaarvoice — Austin, Texas, USA

- Developed and maintained a high-traffic, third-party ratings and reviews application using Backbone.js and jQuery, serving over 400 million unique visitors monthly with strict performance budgets.
- Spearheaded an accessibility overhaul to achieve WCAG 2.0 compliance, expanding market reach and improving usability for all users, while also protecting clients from legal liability.
- Redesigned and optimized the legacy build system, reducing build times from several hours to under 10 minutes and improving CI/CD efficiency for hundreds of client sites.
- Led the Client Satisfaction team: implemented new triage processes and created detailed runbooks, decreasing ticket resolution time and enabling support to independently resolve over 50% of common issues.
- Debugged and fixed critical client-side issues on live production sites, working direction with enterprise clients to resolve urgent problems and maintain SLA compliance.

Tech stack JavaScript, TypeScript, Backbone.js, Node, React, AWS

Education

2013 **Bachelor of Science in Computer Science**

University of Texas — Austin, Texas, United States of America

Extras

2012 **Paddletronic Duel**

Bursting Brains — Austin, Texas, United States of America

Shipped a game on the Google Play store. (It has since been unpublished.)

- Rewrote the AI for computer-controlled opponents.
- Rewrote the physics engine to improve performance.

Gameplay video: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Mw0Mdpc1e8g